



Big Catch For Our Royals
Curt Roberts, left, seen in pose with teammate Bob Aspromonte, is seen as a big catch for Royals. He's a second baseman who is seen as another Jackie Robinson.

Another Jackie!
Infield Star Roberts
Followed Robby's Path

By LLOYD MCGOWAN

Rightfully, Curt Roberts has a first mortgage on Royals' second base.

He came along the same route that Jackie Robinson took in 1946. Now, it is a dozen years later, at least.

Jackie Robinson came from Kansas City Monarchs, most famous of all Negro baseball teams. Curt played for the same club.

Roberts, father of four, is a key player in Royals' bid for their second straight International League pennant under Manager Clay Bryant.

Recently, Curt herded his children and brought them to Montreal from Richmond, Va., where he started the season.

Linda is nine, Curt eight, Philip five and Lieth five months.

"They all like Montreal," Father Curt said. "I would like them to attend school here."

Roberts is the first respected second baseman of the Royals. He has a special pair of glasses for playing, another pair of the same prescription for reading and the street.

"My playing glasses cling to my ears," he said. "They never fall off when I slide into bases."

Roberts is regarded as a good base-runner and slider.

At one time an astigmatism threatened to terminate his baseball career.

Signed By Andy Cohen

Roberts, thirtyish and almost identical in stature to Clyde Paris, Sandy Amoros and Angel Scull, teammates, is out of Pine Land, Texas. However, he now makes his home in Oakland, California. He works for a brewery as a salesman in the offseason.

Originally, Curt was signed out of the Mexican Winter League by Andy Cohen, onetime second baseman of New York Giants. Cohen was then manager of the Denver Club of the Western League.

Denver was then affiliated with New York Yankees but Roberts drifted to Pittsburgh Pirates, then back into the Yankee Network with Richmond Virginians.

Fresco Thompson, the Dodgers' farm foreman, searched for a second baseman for Royals. The Richmond Club was over-stocked with infielders and Fresno purchased Curt for Royals.

Boost For Aspromonte

When with the Pirates, Roberts played under Fred Haney, now Milwaukee manager, and Bobby Bragan, presently skipper of the Dodger-owned Spokane Club of the Pacific Coast League.

"Great guys," he said.

Roberts and Bob Aspromonte, rookie shortstop, form a pretty good keystone combination for Royals. Curt thinks Aspromonte, a bonus baby, stands a good chance to move to the top.

"His hitting has been improving," Curt said. "That's about all he needs. He has the arm, the glove and the speed."

In other words, Aspromonte rates well on the Roberts book as a big-time prospect.

Of all the batters Curt saw in the Majors, he thought Stan Musial of the Cardinals was the best.

"He was always tough to handle," Curt said. "Every time he hit the ball it was pretty tough to handle. Stan was well-liked by everybody — but what a hitter."

Roberts thinks Royals are a pretty good club, as good as any outfit he has seen below the Majors.

"At least, we have plenty of harmony under a great manager," he said. "If our pitching stands up, we shouldn't be too far away in September."

Champion

It's all a big headache to Quinn, who says he will incur additional expenses because of the delay, but it doesn't bother Moore. He's continuing "light" workouts.